

Global Environmental Politics

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Last class: climate change and political mobilization

- No adaptation or relief can increase grievances against govt.
- Govt. can be rationally blamed (rational blame attribution).
- Increases collective action and mobilization (peaceful).
- The way information is presented shapes accountability.
- Needs state capacity (legibility and physical) and low corruption.

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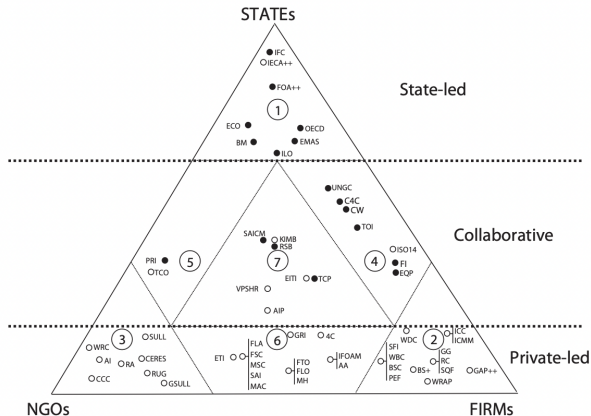
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The international regime complex for climate change

Figure 1.1. The governance triangle



■ The collection of actors, institutions, agreements etc.

■ It has become more complex overtime, especially due to firms.

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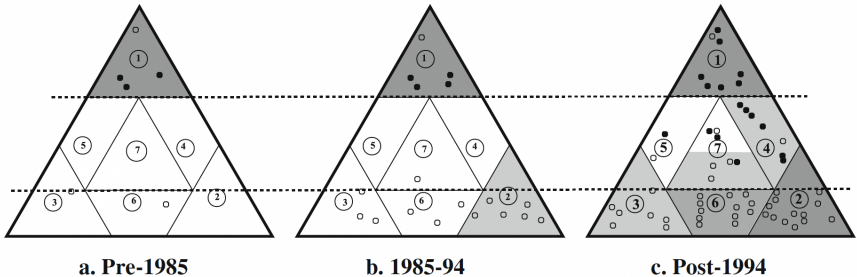


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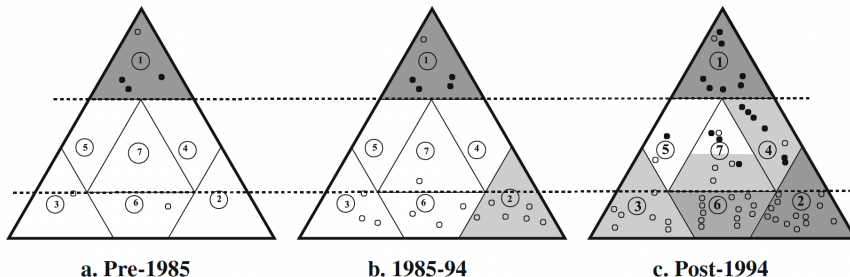


Fig. 2 a–c Evolution of the governance triangle. Shading indicates density of schemes in each zone

- The collection of actors, institutions, agreements etc.
- It has become more complex overtime, especially due to firms.
- What limitations can emerge from this trend?

The international regime complex for climate change

- Many agreements and initiatives for climate change regulation.
- ...bilateral, multilateral, private, mixed.
 - Between countries.
 - International organizations.
 - Between cities.
 - Between companies.
 - Some are Public Private Partnerships (PPPs)
- Fewer actors facilitates consensus (collective action).

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- Creates duplicates with varying levels of quality.
 - International organizations can have more broad expertise.
 - Sub-national government may understand better local needs.
 - Firms may understand better the needs of the industry.
- Makes it hard to standardize and create wider agreement.
- Creates competition and “forum shopping.”
 - Reinforces the role of special interests.
 - Can lead to sub-optimal agreements.
 - In the aggregate it may reduce effective cooperation.
- Competition can create a race to the bottom.

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International Organizations

Core Organizations

UNFCCC: including Kyoto Protocol, organs, funds, and other emanations (R)
 Global Environment Facility (GEF): financial mechanism, special funds
 Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)

Related Organizations

Environmental

United Nations Environment Program (UNEP) (R)
 Montreal Protocol: addresses greenhouse gases (R)

Informal

Group of 8 (G8) (R)
 Group of 20 (G20) (R)
 Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC) (R)
 Major Economies Forum (R)

Sectoral

International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) (R)
 International Maritime Organization (IMO) (R)
 UN Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO) (R)
 International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) (R)
 World Trade Organization (WTO) (R)

Energy

International Energy Agency (IEA)
 International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA) (R)

Development

Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) (R)
 UN Development Program (UNDP) (R)
 World Food Program (WFP)
 World Health Organization (WHO) (R)

Development Banks

World Bank: including Climate Investment Funds, other specialized funds
 Regional Development Banks: African, Asian, Inter-American Development Banks; European Bank for Reconstruction and Development

- **Specialization but also competition.**
- Duplicates efforts with varying advice and standards.
- IOs compete for scarce resources from donors.
- IOs need have incentives to cater to donors' needs.

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Cities as transnational agents



- IOs and national policies may not suit local needs.
- Local needs may be at odds with others' needs.
- Requires coordination (e.g., COP meetings).
- Can generate gridlock and hamstring coordination.

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UN COP16 nature talks gridlocked as conservation funding trickles in

By Jake Spring and Oliver Griffin

October 29, 2024 3:01 PM GMT · Updated 4 months ago



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Climate crisis Middle East Ukraine Football Newsletters Business Environment UK politics Science Tech Global development Obituaries

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Carbon credit trade rules approved, breaking lengthy deadlock - Cop29 day one, as it happened

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Private transnational regulatory organizations

TABLE 2. Climate change-focused PTROs and year established

Business Environmental Leadership Council	1998	Verified (formerly voluntary) Carbon Standard	2006
Cleaner and Greener Certification	1999	CarbonFree Certified	2007
WWF Climate Savers	1999	Climate Counts Scorecard	2007
CarbonNZero	2001	Climate Disclosure Standards Board	2007
Greenhouse Gas Protocol		ClimateWise Principles	2007
Corporate Standard	2001	FTSE4Good Climate Change Criteria	2007
Project Standard	2005	VER+	2007
Product Standard	2011	Carbon Trust Standard	2008
Value Chain Standard	2011	CEMARS	2008
Carbon Disclosure Project		Green-e Climate	2008
Climate Change Program	2003	Social Carbon	2008
Forests Program	2009	American Carbon Registry	2009
Supply Chain Program	2009	Climate Bond Initiative	2011
Carbon Neutral Protocol	2003	International Sustainability and Carbon Certification	2011
Chicago Climate Exchange (offset standards)	2003/2011	NEPCo Carbon Footprint Management Standard	2011
The Gold Standard	2003	REDD+ Social and Environmental Standards	2011
Refrigerants, Naturally!	2004	Natural Forest Standard	2012
Climate, Community and Biodiversity Standards	2005	The W+ Standard	2013
Green Tick Carbon Neutral/Negative	2005		
International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 14000 series standards			
Environmental management standards	2006		
Carbon accounting standards	2006		

■ PTROs adopt voluntary standards using market incentives

■ Consumer demand, reputation, avoid regulation, etc.

■ Can complement IOs norms and programs.

■ Fragile, with higher “death rates” than IGOs.

Private transnational regulatory organizations

TABLE 3. *Diversified PTROs with climate standards and year established*

<i>Business based</i>	
Ethical Tea Partnership	1997
Green Globe Certification Standard for Sustainable Tourism	1999
International Council on Mining and Metals sustainability principles	2003
Program for the Endorsement of Forest Certification	1999
Sustainable Forestry Initiative	1994
<i>Nongovernmental organization based</i>	
Plan Vivo	2008
Rainforest Alliance Sustainable Agriculture Network	1997
Sustainability Consortium	2010
<i>Collaborative</i>	
4C Association code of conduct for coffee	2006
Bonsucro standard for sugar cane	2004
EPEAT standards for electronics products	2005
Equitable Origin standard for petroleum	2009
Fairtrade Labelling Organizations	1997
Forest Stewardship Council	1993
Global Reporting Initiative	1997
Global Roundtable for Sustainable Beef	2010
Global Sustainable Tourism Council	2010
IFOAM organic agriculture standard	1972
Roundtable on Sustainable Biofuels	2007
Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil	2003
Roundtable on Sustainable Soy	2006
UTZ certified standard for agricultural products	2002

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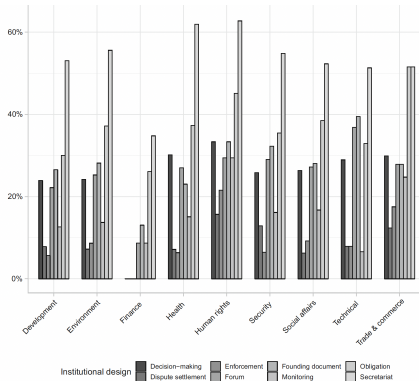


Fig. 4 TGI institutional design across issue areas

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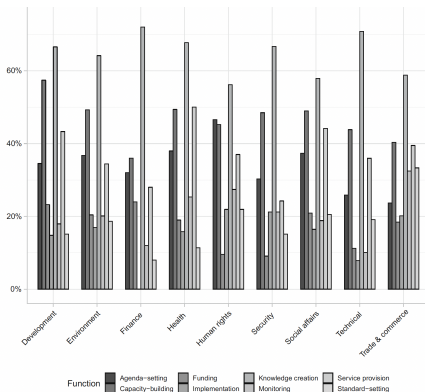


Fig. 2 TGI functions across issue areas

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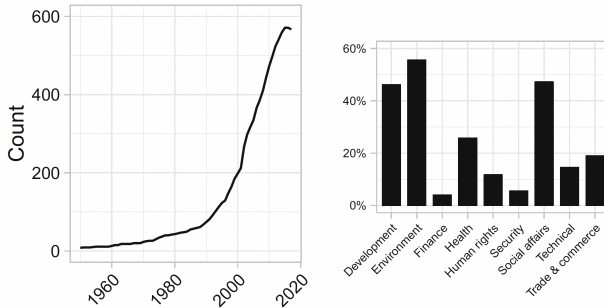


Fig.1 TGI growth and issue areas

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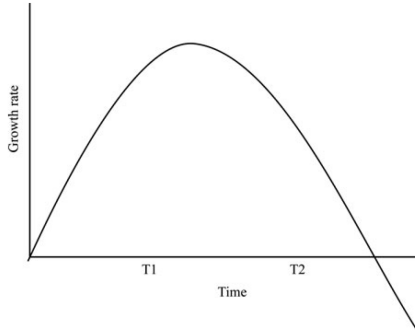


FIGURE 1. *Organizational growth rates over time*

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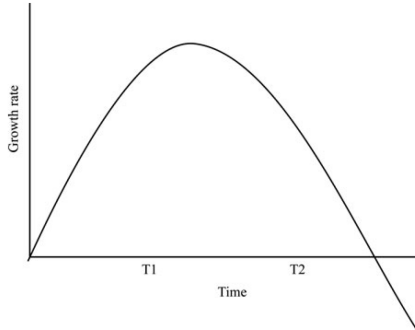


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- Recall... firms look to self-regulating when it benefits them.

Consequence: Poorly designed agreements

Figure 1
The regime complex for managing climate change.



Note: Boxes show the main institutional elements and initiatives that comprise the climate change regime complex. (For a

- Disagreement on measures; unclear incentives to cooperate.
- Vague obligations; discretion; consensus but no enforcement.
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Table 1 | Prospects for coordination and cooperation under four different conditions.

	Potential joint gains are high	Potential joint gains are low
Agreements are not self-enforcing (cooperation is required for collaboration)	Possible cooperation with high rewards, but with dangers of defection that rise with the depth of cooperation.	Little incentive to seek to cooperate, although shallowness of cooperation limits dangers of defection.
Agreements are self-enforcing (coordination is sufficient for collaboration)	Likely coordination, with limited but realizable gains, often leaving potential gains 'on the table'.	Easy coordination, limited by the low level of potential gains.

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Box 1 | The range of interests reflected in national pledges.

- (1) **Create the global public good of reduced climate change.** It might be thought that most countries seek to contribute to a global public good. But only a small fraction of world emissions — perhaps one-quarter or less — comes from jurisdictions such as the EU and some regions in the United States (for example, California and the northeast) — that are primarily motivated by global public goods. For the rest, other logics drive preferences.
- (2) **Create local or national public goods that happen to address, as well, the global public good of climate change.** An example is provided by measures to reduce emissions of soot, or black carbon, which both cause local health problems and contribute to global warming. One of the important advances in climate science over the past decade has been to understand how these 'co-benefits' are linked to global climate change⁷¹. However, most climate science has analysed these links by starting with policies aimed at slowing global warming and showing the local or national co-benefits. A political analysis would emphasize the local benefits, as these often drive policy decisions.
- (3) **Generate competitive economic benefits, such as the creation of new industries — solar, wind, batteries.** Governments will be more interested in emission regulations at home and abroad insofar as they believe that they have competitive advantage, real or potential, in zero-carbon industries, such as solar and wind power. But they may, at the same time, persist in high-emissions activities, especially where vested interests — for instance, in coal power — are strong, so their search for economic benefits can be beneficial or harmful from the standpoint of mitigating climate change.
- (4) **Bargain for side-payments, such as requests for money to help pay the cost of controlling emissions and adapting to climate change.** This motivation is likely to be especially strong for relatively poor developing countries, particularly those countries likely to bear significant costs as they prepare for and adapt to rising sea levels, more extreme weather and other effects of global climate change.
- (5) **Create reputational benefits.** Governments have stakes in a wide variety of issues, and may find it advantageous to be seen as leaders in providing global public goods. According to J. S. Nye, doing so may enhance their 'soft power'⁷². For other states, as climate pledges become the norm, it could be important not to be stigmatized as a non-cooperator, which could hurt the state with respect to issues in which it has clear interests.

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Impossibilities and preference aggregation

- Arrow's impossibility: no system satisfies...
 - Additional option doesn't break agreement.
 - Takes into account all preferences.
 - Makes everyone better off.
 - Non-dictatorship.

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- We can think about welfare-weight aggregation.



(a) Bell shaped



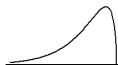
(b) Triangular



(c) Uniform (rectangular)



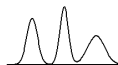
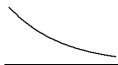
(d) Right skewed



(e) Left skewed



(f) J Shaped



Class exercise: Boosting under-represented groups

- 1 Make groups of 2/3 people.
- 2 The indigenous people's of the Amazon are affected by climate change by are underrepresented in UN's COP.
- 3 How would you increase participation for them at COP?
- 4 How would you ensure that their preferences are incorporated into policy?
- 5 10 minutes.
 - Feel free to use the Internet.



reset